

## 5.5 The Forty-Minute Emotional Filter Build Sprint

### 5.5.1 Filter Build Session Prep Checklist

- ☐ Chapter 3 Seven-Layer Character Excavation profiles open (both characters)
- ☐ Chapter 4 Dialogue Matrix documents open (both characters)
- ☐ Two blank documents ready (one per character's Emotional Filter)
- ☐ AI tool open (needed for Steps 3 and 4)
- ☐ Excavation-to-Filter Mapping Reference visible (section 5.2.1)
- ☐ Timer set for forty minutes

### 5.5.2 Forty-Minute Pacing Guide

| Time Block  | Step   | Focus                                                           |
|-------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0:00–10:00  | Step 1 | Build the Three-Tier Emotional Filter for your grumpy hero      |
| 10:00–20:00 | Step 2 | Build the Three-Tier Emotional Filter for your sunshine heroine |
| 20:00–30:00 | Step 3 | Generate a two-character scene using both filters               |
| 30:00–38:00 | Step 4 | Verify emotional progression across the scene                   |
| 38:00–40:00 | Buffer | Read both filters aloud. Confirm the emotional logic activates. |

### 5.5.3 Grumpy Hero Emotional Filter Template

**Character:** [CHARACTER\_NAME]

**Date:** [DATE]

| Tier                          | Component                            | Your Constraint Statement                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tier One:<br>Baseline         | Default emotional state              | [E.G., "Controlled vigilance masking low-grade fear of being seen as needy"]                                                        |
|                               | Management strategy                  | [E.G., "Keep sentences short. Keep vocabulary blunt. Keep exchanges brief."]                                                        |
|                               | What happens when management relaxes | [E.G., "Sentences lengthen. Vocabulary softens. The character becomes visibly uncomfortable."]                                      |
| Tier Two:<br>Trigger Response | Trigger 1 + staged speech shift      | [E.G., "When asked a direct emotional question: sentences drop to under four words. One trailing fragment leaks. Guard reasserts."] |

| Tier                       | Component                       | Your Constraint Statement                                                                                         |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Trigger 2 + staged speech shift | [E.G., "When the love interest goes quiet: subject change within one turn. Vocabulary narrows to monosyllables."] |
| <b>Tier Three: Subtext</b> | Divergence rule                 | [E.G., "Spoken content is one emotional step removed from felt content."]                                         |
|                            | Two felt-to-spoken translations | [E.G., "Fear → irritation. Tenderness → efficiency."]                                                             |
|                            | Delivery markers (2–3)          | [E.G., "One-beat delay. 'Fine' lands flat. Subject change comes too quickly."]                                    |

## 5.5.4 Sunshine Heroine Emotional Filter Template

**Character:** [CHARACTER\_NAME]

**Date:** [DATE]

| Tier                              | Component                            | Your Constraint Statement                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier One: Baseline</b>         | Default emotional state              | [E.G., "Performative cheerfulness managing a background hum of abandonment anxiety"]                                                           |
|                                   | Management strategy                  | [E.G., "Fill silence. Stack qualifiers. Accelerate speech to prevent pauses."]                                                                 |
|                                   | What happens when management relaxes | [E.G., "Sentences shorten. Intensifiers disappear. The character goes quiet."]                                                                 |
| <b>Tier Two: Trigger Response</b> | Trigger 1 + staged speech shift      | [E.G., "When he goes quiet: sentences accelerate. Three rapid questions. If no response in two turns: cheerfulness drops. One flat sentence."] |
|                                   | Trigger 2 + staged speech shift      | [E.G., "When told she is 'too much': intensifiers multiply. Laughter arrives early. Overexplanation stacks."]                                  |
| <b>Tier Three: Subtext</b>        | Divergence rule                      | [E.G., "Spoken content is one emotional step brighter than felt content."]                                                                     |
|                                   | Two felt-to-spoken translations      | [E.G., "Anxiety → enthusiasm. Hurt → humor."]                                                                                                  |
|                                   | Delivery markers (2–3)               | [E.G., "Exclamation mark arrives too fast. 'Okay so!' resets a real sentence. Laughter ends half a beat early."]                               |

### 5.5.5 AI Prompt Template: Two-Character Scene with Emotional Filters

Use this template to assemble all your materials into a single generation instruction for Step 3 of the sprint.

Copy the prompt below into your AI tool. Fill in every bracket before generating.

Generate a scene (six to eight lines of dialogue) between [CHARACTER\_A\_NAME] and [CHARACTER\_B\_NAME]. One character is trying to reach the other emotionally.

[PASTE\_CHARACTER\_A\_DIALOGUE\_MATRIX]

[PASTE\_CHARACTER\_A\_THREE\_TIER\_EMOTIONAL\_FILTER]

[PASTE\_CHARACTER\_A\_SUBTEXT\_INJECTION\_INSTRUCTION: "In this scene, [CHARACTER\_A] is feeling [FELT\_EMOTION] but expressing [EXPRESSED\_EMOTION]..."]

[PASTE\_CHARACTER\_B\_DIALOGUE\_MATRIX]

[PASTE\_CHARACTER\_B\_THREE\_TIER\_EMOTIONAL\_FILTER]

[PASTE\_CHARACTER\_B\_SUBTEXT\_INJECTION\_INSTRUCTION: "In this scene, [CHARACTER\_B] is feeling [FELT\_EMOTION] but expressing [EXPRESSED\_EMOTION]..."]

Write the dialogue only. No narration. No stage directions. Let the subtext emerge from the rhythm, pacing, and word choice as specified in the filters.

### 5.5.6 Emotional Progression Tracker

Read the generated scene line by line. For each character, track whether the emotional state progresses across the exchange.

Scene: [BRIEF\_DESCRIPTION]

Date: [DATE]

| Line # | Character A State             | Character B State          | Progression Visible? |
|--------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|
| 1      | [E.G., "Guarded, controlled"] | [E.G., "Bright, effusive"] | [Yes / No]           |

| Line # | Character A State | Character B State | Progression Visible? |
|--------|-------------------|-------------------|----------------------|
| 2      | [STATE]           | [STATE]           | [Yes / No]           |
| 3      | [STATE]           | [STATE]           | [Yes / No]           |
| 4      | [STATE]           | [STATE]           | [Yes / No]           |
| 5      | [STATE]           | [STATE]           | [Yes / No]           |
| 6      | [STATE]           | [STATE]           | [Yes / No]           |

### Result:

- ☐ Both characters show a clear shift between the first half and the last two lines → Progression is working. The filter is complete.
- ☐ One character is static → Add a progression clause to that character's Trigger Response tier. Regenerate.
- ☐ Both characters are static → Add progression clauses to both Trigger Response tiers. Regenerate.

**If subtext is still inaudible after two generation passes:** Return to your Subtext Layer and add one more specific behavioral marker to the felt-emotion side. Replace abstract language such as “He feels scared” with an executable instruction like “The sentence arrives one beat late, and the character changes the subject before the other speaker can respond.” After you add that marker, regenerate the dialogue and test it again. The AI will then have concrete rhythmic and behavioral instructions to build the subtext from, and the gap you want will open.